



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 5

CALIFORNIA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside California's family courts and child-welfare system.

226

CALIFORNIA FAMILIES ON RECORD ·
316 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 20
MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF
PARENTING TIME

REPORT GENERATED

MAY 1, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

43 OF 58

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

CALIFORNIA AT A GLANCE.

Across 226 California families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 316 218 of 226 families reported child counts	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$30,000 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 20 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 53.1% 35.8% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 226	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.4	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 218 of 226	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 43

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so California families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF CALIFORNIA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	129	\$30,000	\$87,455	\$11,281,650
Lost Wages	107	\$39,520	\$180,138	\$19,274,720
Other Court Fees	75	\$800	\$9,984	\$748,800
Therapy / Evaluations	96	\$4,500	\$9,591	\$920,690
Reunification Services	83	\$500	\$5,800	\$481,370
GAL Fees	71	\$0	\$9,072	\$644,100
Asset Loss ¹	101	\$42,000	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$117,320	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$42,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



03 WHO IS REPORTING · CALIFORNIA

Most families documenting in California are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

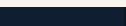
Active case: stuck or delayed		91	40%
Not provided		72	32%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		26	12%
Case closed: within last 2 years		24	11%
Active case: progress being made		2	1%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		82	36%
Family Court Only		71	31%
Unknown		35	15%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		30	13%
Family Court		4	2%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		50	22%
5 – 10 years		39	17%
3 – 5 years		32	14%
6 months – 1 year		30	13%
Over 10 years		20	9%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		64	28%
Visitation Only		52	23%
50/50 Joint		38	17%
Full Custody		21	9%
Children in Foster Care		20	9%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Riverside		19	8%
San Diego		17	8%
Los Angeles		12	5%
Orange		7	3%
San Bernardino		7	3%
Sonoma		6	3%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		62	27%
Other: (Short answer)		36	16%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		34	15%
High Conflict Divorce		21	9%
Family Court		15	7%

05 PARENT VOICES — CALIFORNIA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable California comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



WELL??? WHERE DO I BEGIN??? MY FAMILY HAS BEEN SEVERED! MY PARENTS AND ELDEST SON MICHAEL SIDES WITH THOSE THAT HATE US SO OH WELL... MY ELSEST BOY IS 35 AND A FATHER NOW... HE IS ANGRY BECAUSE HE IS MY HUBBYS HALF SON... MY OTHER 8 HOWEVER??? THE 3 BABIES WERE THANK GOD LEFT ADOPTED [...]

— KIMBERLY

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

This system took my children from me without due process and kept us separated for years based on false allegations and fraud. It destroyed my family, erased irreplaceable years of my children's lives, and caused lasting emotional, financial, and constitutional harm.

— CALIFORNIA PARENT · MORRIS

MORE VOICES FROM CALIFORNIA

CPS destroyed my family, when faced with my knowledge of my rights they violated those rights with no regard for how it would affect my kids who they're supposed to be protecting. They affected 6 kids lives for many years to come and only because I refused to give up did my [...]

— NICOLE

Torn it apart, traumatized my everyday life, I've lost my financial independence, my kids have lost their mother. It has broken trust that I will protect my family when that was ripped from me. I live in fear to conform. My children were also vaccinated with Covid and flu after [...]

— CARMEN

Family court system has traumatized my children with lies,,false allegations and corruption workers making a paycheck off of the trauma they create.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The judge violated my due process rights by not allowing me to have an evident hearing made findings without actually having a hearing I lost contact with my children. I haven't spoken to them in nine months. The judge had a private meeting with the opposing attorney that I was [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Family Court corruption and my narcissistic ex-husband have destroyed my relationship with my two children and has destroyed me and my family and friends lives. Specifically my children's lives.

— KRISTIN

The system has become a partner in crime to my kids dad in continuing to abuse me and my children. The system has created a pain inside of my heart that is unbareable. They are torturing and brainwashing my kids to force them to be apart of their false narrative of me being an [...]

— AMARIS

My 12 year old son and I were ripped apart from each other.he was legally kidnapped.

— SABRINA

Blew up the children's lives through 26 court dates. Kids had to rent rooms in other peoples homes to survive the first 3 years.

— KATE

Creating ptsd, depression, my children are being physically emotionally abused, neglected from quality of life and silenced.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed the loving home my son was in and given to sexual abusers and child pornographers.

— REBECCA

The system has allowed my abuser to confine a campaign of coercive control over me and our dishes life for over 2.5 years. Despite repeated warnings and filings of the court letting them know if the ATROS violations, the harm to my employment, and the reality of his neglect and [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



The Family Court System Felicitated the No Contact Time in which allowed for the process of Parental Alienation that my ex-wife weaponized against me. This evil corrupted system of Judges playing Gods without any recourse action and Money Hungry attorneys milking their clients [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

CPS overturned the crucial virtues, values, ethics and morals I spent 16 years instilling into my daughters In order for them to have a happy, productive life. Our Family was absolutely destroyed as my children watched the system torture their hero-their mommy.

— LORI

destroyed it completely. Cps refused to let me even have a single visir with them, and tampered with drug tests, told my kids I was dirty when I wasnt , proven by hair test.

— BETH

They have stolen my children's innocence, stability, trust, and sparkle.

— CHERISH

This system has destroyed our lives and the lives of my grandchildren.

— ELIZA

It has ruined my children's life and mine as well. My child has extreme PTSD now and is traumatized. I have lost everything just to fight to keep my children from being harmed . My life will never be the same .

— ASHLEY

Cps has traumatized my children. We were failed and then essentially punished by being separated. My kids were brave and tried to save themselves and were shown the opposite of what they deserved and needed.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Traumatizing devastating situations that could result in mental health issues for my children, myself and financial strain for my family. Retaliation at all time high, when legal avenues are resorted to cure the problem.

— KRESHA

Family court has been profiting off of my family while watching my children's childhoods be destroyed with neglect, abuse, and more heartache than any child should have to endure.

— KELLY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Took full custody of my son for a false allegation and CPS report without any substantial evidence and refuse to give him back and continue to force me and my husband to do parenting/protective parenting for over a year now. No end in sight. Children have confirmed with their [...]

— EMILY

the system has stolen 3 kids from my fiancé and i they have completely destroyed our lives our future our happiness and our dream to start a family of our own.

— CAMERON

Traumatized my children, and I have severe PTSD and anxiety ongoing.

— ANDREA

From the very first city dates, the courts stole my children, allowed my children to be abused, hurt, changed schools, homes. Taken from a loving mother and family. (I never ever kept my children from their father) They caused a loss so great, pain, suffering, illness, not to [...]

— JILLIAN

Loma Linda children's hospital and CPS fabricated to reports to kidnap our children and force TPR. No one should need to explain the agony, the trauma, the pain this CPS criminal syndicate inflicts on it's victims. These crimes against humanity are domestic terrorism. It must be [...]

— CHRISTINA

I went from having sole legal and physical custody of my children to losing my job, my home, and my children. I have been silenced and left without a voice in the process.

— SARA

Destroyed my family my children brainwashed the trauma my poor innocent child might suffer is terrifying I'm severely PTSD every time I see a county car or cos I survived with my son who I have full custody of longing fighting for my 5 girls to come home

— ANTOINETTE

CFS has ripped me from my children's lives which has caused extreme behaviors that they are attempting to blame me for.

— LATESHA

Handed my children over to evil. then destroyed my life, put a stain on my reputation, destroyed my ability to create safe relationships due to being labeled a "child abuser" making it impossible for anyone to help me get my children out and safe.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED


Psychological Torture & ongoing trauma.

— KEENAN

They took my five little boys from school their dad died 2 months later just after finding out he was getting her kids back before I did cuz he didn't have allegations against him

— CHRISTINA

They handed over my children to my abuser of 16 years, and placed them in an environment where they'd be emotionally abused by manipulation and alienation from their mother who cared for them 100 percent, when their father never cared for them. Their father has a criminal record [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Torn us apart. Caused unnecessary trauma to children and myself. Took time we never will get back.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has broken our children in a way that is not repairable.

— NATREE

It has caused my kids to be brainwashed in thinking I am an abusive mother. This was their father's brainwashing as well.

— ANNABEL

Forced my husband & I to get divorce, and kidnapped our children

— BRANDI

Destroyed mine and my daughter's lives, mental, emotional, and physical health.

— MEGHAN

Imposed unimaginable trauma and financial devastation for my children and I with life long unrecoverable impacts- scorched earth.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

156 California parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 40 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — CALIFORNIA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from California families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

WELL??? WHERE DO I BEGIN??? MY FAMILY HAS BEEN SEVERED! MY PARENTS AND ELDEST SON MICHAEL SIDES WITH THOSE THAT HATE US SO OH WELL... MY ELSEST BOY IS 35 AND A FATHER NOW... HE IS ANGRY BECAUSE HE IS MY HUBBYS HALF SON... MY OTHER 8 HOWEVER??? THE 3 BABIES WERE THANK GOD LEFT ADOPTED TOGETHER... I SPEAK DAILY TO MY SON JACOB NOW AGE 25! MY DAUGHTER MADISON AND ASHLEY ARE SCARRED AND ARE BEING QUIET HOWEVER MADISON I HAVE SEEN TALKED TO HUGGED CRIED WITH ETC... SHE IS VERY CONFUSED AS THEY ALL ARE TO THIS MOMENT IN TIME!!! This has RUINED MY LIFE! I NOW AM BATTLING CANCER AMONG OTHER TERRIBLE DISEASES FROM TRAUMA!!!! I HAVE PTSD BADLY AND CPTSD TOO! I KNOW MY KIDS WITH ME IN MY LIFE NOW THAT ARE ADULTS WHICH ARE THE MAJORITY OF MY KIDS NOW THAT I INTERACT WITH THANK GOD???!!!! BUT MY KIDS SOME ARE VERY UPSET! ANGRY AT HOW THEY WERE MESSED WITH IN OUR HOME TO BEGIN WITH! SEE WE ACTUALLY WERE WORKING WITHHHH CPS BRUCE SCHMIDT AND HE DREW UP A PAPER WHICH WE HAVE TO THIS DAY IN OUR STORAGE UNIT IN A BOX ALL THE PAPERWORK FROM 2007 BUT THIS ONE SAID CHILDREN ARE TO REMAIN IN HOME!!!!!! IT NEVER WAS SIGNED IN TIME HY A SUPERVISOR???? INSTEAD THEY SHOW UP USING A BENCH WARRANT FOR A VANDALISM CHARGE THAT ONE OF MY SONS DID TO A RENTAL PREVIOUSLY!!!!?? TO REMOVE THE KIDS WITH THAT BENCH WARRANT ALL THE WHILE I GET A LETTER ONE DAY HOW AFTER THEY HAD ALREADY REMOVED MY KIDS A LETTER LETTING US KNOW WE WERE BEING INVESTIGATED FOR CHILD NEGLECT AND TRUANCY??????? THE END GAME??? ADOPTING THOSE AS THE ATTORNEY FOR THE KIDS SAID???? WE DO NOT CARE MISS EYLER ABOUT YOUR LOVE FOR THEM!!!!!!??? only THE BEAUTIFUL BLONDE HAIRED BLUE EYED BABIES?????????!!!!!! ALL THE WHILE TAKING MY 12 YEAR OLD SON

— KIMBERLY (1/2)

TO JUDGES HOMES FRIENDS IF THE ADOPTED FOLKS!!!!!!!!? THOSE THREE OR FOUR SAME JUDGES HAD TO RECUSE THEMSELVES FOR CONFLICT!!!

— KIMBERLY (2/2)

This system took my children from me without due process and kept us separated for years based on false allegations and fraud. It destroyed my family, erased irreplaceable years of my children's lives, and caused lasting emotional, financial, and constitutional harm.

— MORRIS

CPS destroyed my family, when faced with my knowledge of my rights they violated those rights with no regard for how it would affect my kids who they're supposed to be protecting. They affected 6 kids lives for many years to come and only because I refused to give up did my babies come home.

— NICOLE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Torn it apart, traumatized my everyday life, I've lost my financial independence, my kids have lost their mother. It has broken trust that I will protect my family when that was ripped from me. I live in fear to conform. My children were also vaccinated with Covid and flu after I asked them not to. I feel I've lost all my parental rights for their paychecks. I've become the outsider within my own family and relationship with my girls.

— CARMEN

Family court system has traumatized my children with lies,,false allegations and corruption workers making a paycheck off of the trauma they create.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The judge violated my due process rights by not allowing me to have an evident hearing made findings without actually having a hearing I lost contact with my children. I haven't spoken to them in nine months. The judge had a private meeting with the opposing attorney that I was never informed about and learned about later. The judge basically just did whatever he wanted to do. I don't understand why he did this. It's ridiculous that you could call the police on someone and the police find that no abuse took place, but then use that as evidence against the persimmon court. It's irrelevant and improper to make a finding an order after hearing, but never have a Hearing these judges are criminal. I need to be prosecuted.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family Court corruption and my narcissistic ex-husband have destroyed my relationship with my two children and has destroyed me and my family and friends lives. Specifically my children's lives.

— KRISTIN

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— AMARIS

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— SABRINA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Blew up the children's lives through 26 court dates. Kids had to rent rooms in other peoples homes to survive the first 3 years.

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The system has allowed my abuser to confine a campaign of coercive control over me and our dishes life for over 2.5 years. Despite repeated warnings and filings of the court letting them know if the ATROS violations, the harm to my employment, and the reality of his neglect and control they did nothing. I lost my job and my income because of his unrelenting efforts to sabotage my independence, he harassed me and threatened me directly and then clearly submitted false documentation to the court and for away with it, he has failed to pay child support properly and has hidden and misrepresented his income repeatedly, claiming poverty while paying \$500 for his attorney. The courts solve was to ask his attorney if a special master known to the opposing attorney could still do a report... they work in the same complex, know eachother staff by first name and emailed immediately, they were charging us over \$4000 just for a retainer and no promise of accuracy. O cannot afford to pay for special masters when I've lost a good job and I'm not receiving adequate support. When my ex violated orders the court will say "these are just temporary orders" but I've been trapped in the system since October of 2023. The court in filings has been made aware repeatedly of his ATROs violations and then when addressing the filing about the ATROs violations with evidence, she says "well I haven't seen anything filed on the ATROs - if you file it we can address it" - she says this with an official filing about the ATROs as her reference. It makes no sense. I was told to meet and confer with opposing counsel, who claimed his software wasn't working and lured me to his office. This was at the judges

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (1/3)

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

admonishment of me and directive to “meet and confer” I went to his office there was no one else there and he ignored calls from the court house when I tried to go back and secure support. We were pushed 4 months out. He then lied repeatedly under oath. I was granted an ex parte but then at the day of the hearing he again presented false numbers and the judge asked him about a special master. He literally got to choose someone he knows. In the midst of all of this our daughters schedule was a disaster- since my ex spent almost no time with her until the day after getting an attorney only a few months before our first custody hearing he suddenly wanted more time with her than he could even possibly execute. We landed on 70/30 ordered by the judge only for her to immediately mathematically undermine herself. Our daughter’s schedule was functionally inversed while she ordered a “70/30” and claimed that she was adopting the FCs recommendation with “one small change” that one small change completely flipped our daughters life upside down. I then had to do 6 or 7 exchanges each week. Never on the same days and each time bringing more chaos. This went on for more than 20 months. Our daughter has missed out on so much. This system is completely broken and corrupt. I write this as what most would consider a successful pro se litigant. I have learned from all of you. I have 85% custody but that reflects life before separation. The judge didn’t make it right I did, and eventually my ex just stopped caring so much about the time because he didn’t care about the time but it’s still all about money for him. He did all of this to avoid paying child support. All of it was about ci ril.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (2/3)

He tried to destroy me my job, my ability to care for one child, he cancelled my health insurance he has caused so much medical emotional psychological harm and he has not faced a SINGLE consequence.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT (3/3)

The Family Court System Felicitated the No Contact Time in which allowed for the process of Parental Alienation that my ex-wife weaponized against me. This evil corrupted system of Judges playing Gods without any recourse action and Money Hungry attorneys milking their clients dry by extending hearings, both parties made my ex-wife and I dislike and lose trust for one another which unreturned we both lost sight of the important part “Our rights as parents”.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— KELLY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Took full custody of my son for a false allegation and CPS report without any substantial evidence and refuse to give him back and continue to force me and my husband to do parenting/protective parenting for over a year now. No end in sight. Children have confirmed with their court ordered counselors that the allegations were false and still have zero custody back. I have been the main custodian for their whole life until the allegations. Children are now being mentally and verbally abused by dad and step mom, also confirmed with counselors, and their mental health has drastically gone downhill. Extreme alienation since before the false allegations. Son is being called a different name by dad and stepmom, making comments about me (bio mom) and his faith. All calls between me and my son have been audio and video recorded. Son gets sent with gps tracking watch while in my care. Much much more.

— EMILY

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— JILLIAN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Torn us apart. Caused unnecessary trauma to children and myself. Took time we never will get back.

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— MEGHAN

Imposed unimaginable trauma and financial devastation for my children and I with life long unrecoverable impacts- scorched earth.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Kidnapped my kids and stole my motherhood.tore my family apart and made me mentally unstable

— KAMI

False allegations she has a high price attorney \$500 an hour then they put her attorney fees on me False evidence False witnesses false testimony, I mean it's a regular kangaroo cord over here

— WESLEY

Destroyed my bond with my son I was primary parent it's traumatized my son and has mentally emotionally taken a toll and psychologically maltreatment his dad sabotaged me while he left which created more trauma as I was being harassed as well as my son systematically

— KATIE

Destroyed my children in every aspect, mentally, emotionally. They were never heard, and simply no one cared what my ex did to me in front of them nor do they care how he abused my children in multiple ways.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judicial corruption, deception and attorney collusion especially in family and probate courts are nothing less than a business. There is a brotherhood among judges that protect the unethical actions. How can you get a fair trial when favoritism and nepotism the driving force among judges and attorneys. Engineered chaos to loose money at its best.

— KEVIN

False allegation was substantiated without due process. Grandchildren removed from us and never seen or heard from again. CPS and the courts have too much power over our families. We need due process if you are going to steal our children from us and cause such harm to all involved. Stop funding the corrupt family court system, find a better way.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Stole my kids from hospital my daughter's (twins) was born on my 1 year recovery date and CPS took them

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Couse me to sepearate me from kids and alienated depressed and mentally unstable and the care giver mover further to prevent me to visit them

— ANGEL

The system has destroyed my family and our lives. It has rewarded and protected the criminals and rewarded and protected the abusers and system manipulators.

— ROBERT

Tried to kill me. I don't know my kids. They let my mother just do that. I've been homeless, and that was the excuse they needed 2vyears later. It's caused me to have no faith in society and trust issues with everyone. Everything that was stolen from me was taken from my kids also.

— CHRISTINE

It destroyed my family, killed my soul, shattered my dreams, traumatized me and made me feel hopeless and helpless knowing they were gaslighting me all along.

— CINDY

It has destroyed the Whole Family and taken away my Constitutional Rights without Due Process!! I want to be on stages, telling my story, so others can see who this made me and how it built a Warrior for Justice

— MATTHEW

Took my love for my family and did it willing in my face like a monster in a movie!

— IVYANNE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

We are suffering from PTSD from CPS and the Cops kids and I still suffer daily from the governments actions

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They destroyed my life and the relationship I had with my kids most importantly and a ton of money. My reputation and being able to get my dream job was also destroyed which crushes my soul.

— SHAUNA

We have lost everything because of our legal cases with convicted DV abuser and his 3rd party, including being sued for \$20million. I have been obtaining help & support thru local DV shelter to help rebuild. Marjoree Mason Center, Fresno, CA

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

permanently traumatized my son so that he can't ever sleep alone 4 years later. I have panic attacks and am in therapy for the trauma from CP workers. They ruined my ability to work around children or my career. Everything they claimed to me was disproved and my son was returned to me in 6 weeks.

— CHRISTINA

Destroyed my family , taken any sort of money to rebuild our home . We are traveling 350 miles a week to do classes and visits

— MONICA

No due process And didn't allow my witnesses or evidence in

— KRISTINA BARRERA

It's stolen precious moments that I can't get back. My daughter was taken during the critical bonding time. There are answers that professionals ask me about my childrens' development that I can't answer because I wasn't there

— KRYSTAL

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They have caused, Emotional trauma and stress along with Mental and Physical Health issues stemming from it all,

— KRISTAL

DESTROYED our family by destroying evidence to keep the father out knowing that the mother was the perpetrator.

— STEPHEN

When I left an abusive relationship, my ex used false accusations against me, and the system added to our trauma instead of bringing protection and justice.

— YHAJIRA

The very system designed to protect children's best interest failed us. I made choices to keep me and my children breathing and protect us from the abuse as much as I was allowed but this has marred their future with an emotional scar that we will forever carry

— LORENA

They have ripped my children away and placed them with the abuser because they were too lazy to investigate and because they came into my home with a preconceived notion. I am nothing without my children. The system has ruined our life and allowed my children to still be sexually abused till this day.

— TAMARA

It has ripped my daughter from her home and her mother and everything she knows.

— MELISSA

My children's biological mother has turned into a walking shell of emptiness with extinguished hope, only a voice

— KATHARINA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has destroyed my faith in the system and is deteriorating my health

— JAMIE

My only son was legally kidnapped by his abusers after I reported abuse that my son disclosed to me that he endured during his father's visitation time approximately over a year ago

— AVA

Destroyed my will to live and left me permanently scarred

— AMBER

It has further enabled my abuser to abuse me Post separation labeling it as high conflict, this is not high conflict. It's for separation abuse and it's utilizing the court system and child protective service , and the only true victim in this matter is our child!

— ALISSAR

Destroyed. Children lost potential and access to positive role models and a childhood that could have been filled with family functions and activities with friends. Now they live isolated with their abuser on tablets, video games, unrestricted access to YouTube, and reshare disturbing age in appropriate content some of it mature in nature. Destroyed innocent children

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Miners council became biased after talking with my ex and his attorney. Court involved therapists are friends with the new judges. The system is rigged. Court racketeering. Susan bassie

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Distroyed my large family, my business of 30 years,used a restraining order as evidence even though the evidence shows that my wife was the only aggressor and lied to the sheriff,judges,and on declarations.

— WILLIAM

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

There's always in the favor of the abuser, monster parent and torn my family apart . But they get paid and sleep well at night knowing what they did was wrong. Justice will be served and system has to change

— DIANA

Family court and child welfare failed my children and me by allowing allegations, unfair process, and lack of accountability to take away years of my relationship with them. As a person born with disabilities, I want people to know this system can silence vulnerable parents and leave families permanently harmed.

— SALLY

I have proof of minors counsel and the custody evaluator deleting forensic medical evidence from our custody evaluation. I can't report their illegal actions because the judge put a gag order on me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family law court allowed false parental alienation accusations to actually result in allowing the respondent, who was abusive, to alienate me from one of my children for almost 2 years. My other child is being forced to share custody with an unsafe parent in a dangerous situation that the minor's counsel informed the judge of, but was ignored and disregarded. My child has begged to not go out of fear.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They divided us and took a piece of me that they can never fix. My heart is shattered.

— KRYSTAL

Caused severe emotional trauma to both my child and myself

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated a present and involved mother from kids.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Lost time with are new born Grandson overall 1 1/2. Yr

— LARRY

The family court judge, in alliance with my daughters father denied my evidence to protect him. My daughter and my restraining order was denied along with medical records.

— ROSA EDITH

Court Purposely caused my disabled child to lose his Social Security income, constant pure negligence of mandatory statutes

— LACEY

My wife failed to finalize our divorce before remarrying and then she weaponized the court against me via perjury to alienate me from our son for the last 7 years. I've been totally destroyed by all of this.

— JUSTIN

"Best interest of the child" became the justification while my daughter was traumatized, the danger she faced was ignored, and I was punished and silenced for trying to protect her. After hundreds of thousands of dollars has been extorted from me—and counting—no one can give a single credible reason why my child is being kept from me. That isn't justice—it's corruption, greed, and a racket.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

you have destroyed what was left of the good in me. Something I can't fix, and I dont know if I have the strength to try.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Is trying to empty all my accounts and bankrupt me completely. Ignores evidence and only grants lawyers RFO not pro-se litigants (zero consideration) while kids have been traumatized by the ex

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Forced separation tried to force divorce made me choose between spouse and children . When separated from spouse was told mentally unfit to keep my kids, when reconciliation was made with spouse was told that I was failing to protect my kids.Was bullied and could do nothing right.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Denied justice and ignored an active DRVO in Sutter county, because child custody was already in placer county. Yet an abuser isn't allowed to have half custody. After leaving and protecting my children. I got Silenced and couldn't speak the truth. Took his money and allowed him to continuously lie and manipulate court to benefit him. Cost me outrageous court fees I can't afford and endangering my children and I who are poverty stricken and I'm am disabled as well as now know he gave me a brain injury. Which could lead to stroke or death etc. also the furthered continued abuse to force me to call him pops and the forced live in two counties of his choice harmed income and job growth as well as more PTSD from forced hand overs and told I am unable to record the drop offs or have a friend hand her over. My body swells from instant sight of my abuser. He is slowly killing me and I'm being silenced.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They caused my kids Capital T trauma, which will last for a lifetime and will impact my grandkids in the future, my kids future relationships, and the testimony of their life.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have made sure my children have lost everything their home they grew up in their cloths their toys there mother their friends my children are now not their happy self's

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Broke up a happy home separated sibblings placed them with abusive strangers and exploited them to no return

— MESHARI

Strong family into a broken family. Their goals in reality

— DREW

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They ignore my loss of time all missed visits all missed phone calls YEARS.,My attorney subpoenaed two police officers they showed up to court but were sent home. The Judge only took testimony of opposing not the police

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My child now has separation anxiety stemming from abuse in foster care.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has failed my family

— REBEKAH

They have stolen precious moments and deprived two children from their mother, my eldest daughter is now a teenager and is in her crucial years of needing a mother as she is shifting into a young woman

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Waiting on custody evaluation report for more than 7 months. Denial of physical abuse and thrown into 50-50 custody but am afraid to refile to modify prior to custody report given the statements made by the judge in the DVRO hearing.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Since I refused services because I felt I didn't do anything to endanger my daughter the judge gave her mother full custody and only gave me an hour once a month of supervised visits

— TREMAYNE

Torn child from her primary caregiver over false domestic violence allegations, emergency orders, preying attorneys and outside corroborating parties do profit over child best interest or truth. Broken emotionally, financially before truth came out.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I nightmare you never wake up from!

— ALAINA

It has taken everything from me. My family, my mental, emotional and physical health as well as financial resources

— JOSEPHINE

Robbed my family of time together. My son's first toddler milestones. Fighting reunification all while saying they are trying to reunify. Religious rights violated. They never asked religious preferences. Trauma!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has made our lives a living nightmare. Hard to even function and still live daily lives.

— CA

Separated me from my son. Took away my chance to be a father. Only allowing me 4 days a month to be a father and siding with the mother.

— DIVINE

Took all my rights as a father with no cause. My Mother wasn't given a chance to petition for custody of my Son. The CWS is only working with the couple they gave my Son to & lied about being able to have contact with or any updates on how he is doing.

— JONATHAN

Destroyed my family.

— HEATHER

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Has decimated my faith in child welfare and protection systems. My nieces were court-napped. We believe their abuse disclosures against their father. Family court judge and minors' council suppressed his documented CSA history.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have no retirement and no stability which will impact our children in the future when they need to lean on family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has made me believe they will not help keep myself or my children safe from a predator. They would rather make money at the suffering of families all over the world as Destruction of the family unit is the number one goal.

— MARISA

The court enabled my EX to give our son a new Mom and cancelled me as a Mother.

— WREN

I had to fight for 4 years to be in my son's life, lost career, money etc.

— TIMOTHY

CPS claimed there was domestic violence (there was none ever) false statements in reports saying there was although none of what they claimed happened actually happened, provided proof it didn't happen & was ignored, used my disability against me and that I'm a veteran. Away from my son for almost a year now and said my wife & I can't be together otherwise she can't have our son back. Tore apart our family and lost over \$500k already, still trying to stay strong.

— JERETT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My revengeful ex has used the system to destroy my life and the relationship I have with my kids. It has emotionally and financially devastated me and I don't know if I will ever recover.

— JADE

Has hurt them more than I can say have been taken out of my house bought 9 years before marriage title says sole and seperate property

— CHARLES

It was just me and my son, the system deprived me of raising my son who won't ever know who I am...

— ALYSSA

This system killed my younger son by allowing his drug addicted father and his drug addicted abusive wife unsupervised visits with our son.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Constantly driving controversy. Individuals are encouraged to nit pick every negative aspect of their coparent instead of working to compromise and legitimately find the best interest of the child. Ridiculous kangaroo court where one biased judge can take everything from you based on lies and constant deciet. Even after the lies are documented and proven Judge Santana has continuously ignored fact for fiction and allowed the local attorney to say or do whatever she wants in court with no accountability or retribution.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I now have two emotionally damaged children and have been barred from helping them. If I had learned to lie, maybe I could have more than 15 minutes a month with my 14 year-old daughter.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Even when a mother follows every court order and provides documented evidence, the system can still mischaracterize her actions and make decisions that disrupt her children's stability and prolong conflict.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

"I have been cut off from my 17- and 14-year-old children since October through one-sided ex parte orders despite being found to be a safe parent and despite their repeated statements that they want to be with me. The court ignored the evidence and their voices and continues forcing a situation that is clearly failing—even when authorities could not enforce it and I was not involved."

— LACY

I'm devastated, they all know that allegations are lies, and that my ex is abusive, yet they continue depriving me of my child. I will sue them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have lost complete contact with my 16-year-old son this year -alienation, he's on drugs and completely disowned me because I took away his Xbox and his dad convinced me that I was a horrible person and I was ruining his life. my 15-year-old son is in the ICU currently from being forced to have a brain surgery that was elective, when his dad claimed it was an emergency surgery after he filed a restraining order to have me removed from custody physical and legal custody. I could have protected him - now he can't speak or walk anymore, we don't know how damaged he is neurologically and he had a brain bleed after his surgery. I have no money, I've lost my job and lots of other opportunities, my entire life was spent fighting this case, to protect my kids, the loss is astronomical

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Made me stronger bitch

— YOUR

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system in Santa Barbara is a joke they have uneducated people acting as social workers and they accept the utter lies from anonymous callers and don't bother to verify a thing! The case workers retaliate against parents and the judge lets it happen again and again. My rights were terminated during the COVID19 pandemic on top of it all! Insanity!!!!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The best strategy for any child over 16 is simply to refuse to litigate. You can't have a one sided argument. You can't win so refuse to play.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has allowed the Father to continue the abuse and take some of my custody away for no reason. Has changed the stipulated agreement then made me liable for thousands of dollars The commissioner decisions have cost me thousands taking me into a bankruptcy situation while the other party continues to break the court orders.

— MARISOL

It has completely torn our family apart. My daughters are sick behind their brother being removed so abruptly, and my son is an autistic child. He has been ripped away from the only family he knows.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Minimized the domestic abuse I endured, by suggesting it was "coparenting conflict." Twisted the narrative and ignored evidence to justify placing my child with her abuser when all I did was seek help when my child was reporting abuse from the other parent.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system has torn my family apart—ignoring my child's fear, silencing our voices, and forcing us into a situation that prioritizes procedure over protection and truth.

— LINDSAY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has ripped the unity of my family apart. It has allowed my daughter to not get proper treatment. My son has not been in therapy to process all his feelings. He told my therapist he wanted to be a serial killer.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system treated me like a criminal while protecting the real offenders, causing lasting harm to my child and myself. Despite proving the falsehoods spread by my ex, I continue to face financial and reputational damage, leaving me feeling trapped and suffering from PTSD.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has allowed the other parent to file multiple, meritless, and frivolous court filings without evidence while dragging court hearings and allowing them to extend trials keeping me away from my children. I have missed precious time with them that I will never get back. I have missed school family events, sporting events, holidays and birthdays. The other parent made them assume that I had done something wrong. Meanwhile I have spent more than their 4 combined college tuitions to fight the other parent in court and I still don't have my kids back 50/50 even after the last two DV request were denied and found not credible.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has taken all Faith from my younger children that we will protect them away and has tried to suffer the bond which has been unsuccessful in the most current court report it says that our visits are detrimental because it gives our children hope that they're coming home one day when it doesn't coincide with the permanent plan of adoption which has always been part of their plan two weeks after the children were taken the eight month old was taken to another county and put in a foster home with a different family and we had to call the police to have them tell us where she was because she was supposed to be at a visit with us and she was in the process of being adopted out

— JUAN

In CA if abuse has been found FC 3044 is suppose to protect us. It was removed from our case by one judge and further abuse happened. Another judge re added it, but gave Father more time. Both our son and I have a 10yr Criminal Protective Order. The courts think it's ok to keep increasing visitation with our abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Caused parental alienation, caused my son hearing loss from medical abuse from father, child has adhd but I think it's truly severe anxiety, child has impulse control issues. Father is allowed to continue to abuse me even in co-parenting therapy I live in fear daily of the false allegations from father.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They didn't come with a solution, they came with a reason to take my baby the hospital claimed they ran a urinalysis that resulted in positive for meth, there was a collection pouch on my daughter since birth so impossible to have collected a urine sample. They tore my family apart!

— JAMES

Scared the crap out of my kids, they literally thought they couldn't make any mistakes, otherwise they would be taken from us. Thankfully I have a great partner, but I've seen families torn apart, and it's sad, the kids get hurt so badly.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This "system" of evil staffed by those directly from the depths of Hell completely destroyed my daughters childhood and all future opportunities of success. As well as destroying my military and civilian careers, health, finances, reputation, relationships with family and friends, and all future opportunities.

— JASON

Absolute Destruction of parent child bond

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My abuser, with the help of the system, has obliterated my life and has caused extensive damage to the health, safety, and well-being of my child. At 40-years old, as I fight to regain custody, I also have to rebuild my entire life from rubble because I literally have nothing left.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The best interest of the child is not what this this about, the kids can't won't be heard & why have an order if no one will uphold it but will make protective parent go through so much more.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

After serving as the stay-at-home mother for 8 years, I was removed from our joint lease home with nothing. My ex now withholds the children's clothing, artwork, and my personal belongings while using the TRO and court process to maintain control, leaving me financially destabilized and the children missing their things.

— OXANA

Permitting a habitual absconder to run with a child, claiming jurisdiction over the child and never enforcing absconding, visitation or custody interference.

— STEPHEN

I was the victim of domestic violence but because he had his sister there when it happened they spun it to say that I was the dominant aggressor. Another judge had granted me custody of our daughter 2 days prior until the case could be heard in San Diego. The San Diego judge took custody from me (her primary caregiver) and gave it to him. I will have lost 5 months with my daughter by the time we have our court date. My daughter is suffering being away from me.

— GRACE

My ex weaponized the Hague convention by claiming our family had loved in Italy fir the past 10 years - a country we have no ties to, we don't speak the language, we aren't citizebs, we have no friends or family in Italy, we have no ethnic nor cultural connections to Italy, and via the Hague Convention he successfully haf our 3 US citizen children deported to Italy, a country completely foreign to thsm. My abusive ex was so enraged that he had lost his grip of coercive control over us, he had to weaponize international treaties through the family court system to isolate us in a foreign country.

— SARA

Completely Dissected It

— NATASHA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system separated our family and deprived us of irreplaceable time together based on unproven allegations, disputed medical assumptions, and suppressed evidence rather than competent findings. In doing so, it replaced due process with speculation, causing lasting harm to our children and our family's stability.

— JESSICA

Family court didn't just take time from me—it rewrote my motherhood in legal terms, where love became limited and distance was enforced. Family court is a racket that partakes in legalized kidnapping when a parent is forced out of their child's everyday life and made to pay hundreds of thousands of dollars for limited contact.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I'm exhausted and losing a battle to the system who is being played by my narcissistic ex, and my daughter is suffering, yet there's no help for stay at home moms trying to fight against the system and someone who knows how to manipulate it and is suffocating all your resources and committing financial, emotional and psychological abuse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family justice system has further proven its inability to make the right decision or put what's in the child's best interest first. Instead, they have continued to support the alienation and protect a pedophile.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My relationship with my child is but a remnant of what it was. They are closed off due to what the other parental unit did and said to them. Then other unit now has started to issue death threats towards bottle the child and myself, blaming us for what has happened to them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

systemic due process violations and unlawful wage/benefit seizures carried out by multiple state child support enforcement agencies. From approximately 2008 through 2024, child support agencies in California, Missouri, and Kansas initiated and enforced multiple Income Withholding Orders (IWOs) and intercept actions against me, resulting in: • Wage garnishments through multiple employers (documented via ADP records) • Tax intercepts (state and federal) • Unemployment benefit intercepts • Passport denial • Continued enforcement despite unanswered formal records requests

— K

They believed our daughter was better off with the mother which is far from the truth. Her eldest son is a convicted murderer. She has another baby daddy.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

When we left, he said, "I will make your life a living hell". And with the help of the family court system, including a custody evaluator, he did. The custoday evaluator eventually said, "You have the right to be angry with me for the rest of your life." The problem is we have to live with the consequences, not her.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

156 full approved California comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT**WHAT THIS IS**

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this California report comes from California respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in California — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 226 California families reporting here are not the universe of California families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 5 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

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